

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Epson Perfection 2450 Photo

Photo perfect!

The Epson Perfection 2450 Photo is a scanner aimed squarely at high-end graphics professional. It allows you to scan photographs and transparencies at resolutions of 2400x4800 at 48-bit colour depth.

The Epson Perfection uses a USB 1.1 interface and also has integrated FireWire functionality for faster data transfer. We found the installation effortless; Windows XP detected it immediately. It performed very well in the image quality test, producing an extremely crisp image with vivid colour reproduction. In the photograph test, it scored an impressive 9 out of 10 and had excellent tonal range, scoring 8 out of 10 in that test. The scanner completed the image preview in an amazing 6.6 seconds,



beating the previous record of 8 seconds set by HP ScanJet 5470C in our scanner comparison in the August 2002 issue. It performed exceedingly well in the resolution test too, scoring 4 out of 5 and lived up to its supported hardware resolution. With brilliant imaging qualities, this scanner is tailor-made for applications in design studios and for print production.

SPECIFICATIONS

Resolution of 2400x4800, 48-bit colour depth, USB 1.1 and IEEE 1394 FireWire interface

Price: Rs 32,500
Company: Epson India Ltd
Phone: 080-5321266
E-mail: azra@eid.epson.co.in
Web site: www.epson.co.in

Epson Perfection 2450 B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶

LITEON CD-ReWriter 40/12/48x

The fast and the furious

The LITEON CD-ReWriter requires fast media to exploit its true potential. We tested it with Imation's 40x compatible media. It wrote our 700 MB ISO file in a fast 3 minutes 44 seconds, beating

the previous record holder ASUS CRW-2410S by 17 sec-



onds. In the assorted file test, 650 MB worth of small files and folders with long file names were burnt in 3 minutes 20 seconds flat! Audio extraction speeds were pretty fast too—2 minutes to rip an Audio CD with 14 tracks totalling 64 minutes 2 seconds. At 40x write speeds, the writer burns data at an amazing speed of 6000 KBps. This can be a really high number to sustain for slower systems and

Price: Rs 4,200
Contact: Mediatech India
Phone: 022-2396696
E-mail: sales@mediatechindia.com

though the CD-ReWriter supports buffer underrun technology, we recommend a 7,200-rpm hard drive if you intend to burn at such high speeds.

SPECIFICATIONS

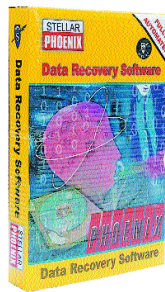
ATAPI Enhanced IDE interface, supports up to Ultra-DMA Mode2 33.3 MBps, 80 ms (typical) access time, 2 MB buffer memory

LITEON CD-ReWriter B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶

Stellar Phoenix

To data loss and back!

This tool allows you to recover data from a logically damaged hard disk. It offers recovery from accidental formats, partition loss, virus-related corruption, file/directory deletion, even total disk corruption. It can identify inaccessible drives, and locate and present all the partitions in a list. It need not be installed prior to a data loss incident and has no drive capacity limitation. Strangely, the product comes with a 10-count recovery limitation, limiting your usage. For further use, you will have to renew the licence. We tested the software by doing a quick format of a



partition; it showed us the exact tree structure of the directories and recovered all our data.

The software does have a few limitations though—it will not work if the drive cannot be detected in the BIOS. Also, if you acci-

dentally perform a quick format and then write data onto the freshly formatted disk, the chances of data recovery are reduced dramatically.

SPECIFICATIONS

Minimum System Requirements: a working hard disk and floppy disk drive, 32 MB RAM (64 MB recommended), MS-DOS 5.0 or Windows 3.x/9x/Me

Price: Rs 4,000
Company: Stellar Information Systems Ltd.
Phone: 011-6418809
E-mail: sales@stellarinfo.com
Web site: www.stellarinfo.com

Stellar Phoenix B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶